17.2 Croup (Laryngotracheobronchitis)

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • Mother says • "He has a barking cough and noisy breathing at night." **Objective** • Barking cough • Stridor on breathing in, even at rest • Suprasternal recession	**ACTUAL** **Ineffective breathing pattern** related to laryngeal edema as evidenced by stridor and retractions.	Within 4 hours, no stridor at rest.	• Keep him calm on his parent's lap and avoid anything that will upset him. • Give oral or nebulised steroid and nebulised adrenaline as prescribed. • If SpO_2 is low, give oxygen. • Never look in his throat. • Watch RR, stridor, SpO_2 and level of consciousness.	No stridor at rest: **goal met**.
Subjective • Mother says • "I am scared he will stop breathing." **Objective** • Mother tearful • Child crying	**ACTUAL** **Anxiety (parent and child)** related to breathing difficulty as evidenced by crying and expressed fear.	Parent and child look calmer.	• Explain the treatment. • Keep the parent with the child. • Cut down noise and stimulation.	Calmer: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Upper airway swollen	**RISK** **Risk for suffocation** as evidenced by risk factors: progressive upper airway swelling.	Any worsening of the obstruction is spotted and treated early.	• Report agitation, drowsiness, cyanosis, or stridor getting quieter while distress gets worse. • Have emergency airway equipment ready. • Never leave him alone.	No deterioration: **goal met**.